

BATTING SOARS, BUT BOWLERS KEEP THE ROOF ON

In IPL 2025, explosive batting has been met with a **strategic bowling response**. Discover how bowlers have found their groove, keeping run rates in check despite high expectations.

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In the wake of a record-breaking 2024 season, where batters plundered runs at an unprecedented rate, the Indian Premier League (IPL) entered 2025 bracing for even more stratospheric standards. An ultra-aggressive brand of batting had become the norm, and the race for the league's first-ever 300-plus total was well and truly on — it felt like only a matter of time.

Expectedly, Sunrisers Hyderabad came frighteningly close to it in the second match of the season, ransacking 286 in a run-fest against Rajasthan Royals. However, 50 matches into the season, no team has breached the 250-run mark since, and Sunrisers are languishing towards the bottom of the standings.

There was a 6.34 per cent increase in scoring rates from 2023 to 2024, with the IPL ushering in the Impact Player era. However, that upward swing didn't sustain, and the bowlers found a way to remain relevant.

On the face of it, the overall run rate (9.41) in the ongoing season (after 50 matches) is just a shade lower than last year (9.56). Still, there seems to be a more judicious balance between bat and ball in 2025, perhaps because the runs are more evenly spread out. Eight of the tournament's 10 highest team totals were registered in 2024, while 2025 has a solitary entry on that list. The total number of sixes after 50 games has dropped from 903 in 2024 to 833 in 2025; the fours have reduced from 1553 to 1522, and while the tally of 50-plus individual scores is level at 111, this season has witnessed just four centuries after 50 games, compared to 11 in 2024.

The difference in run rates in the PowerPlay and middle overs (7 to 15) between 2024 and 2025 is negligible, but the scoring rate in the